ABERDARE TECHNICAL COLLEGE
PRACTICAL OBSERVATION CHECKLIST
COMPUTER ESSENTIALS
ICT Level 5
Unit code: 0611 351 01AG
Element 3: Perform File Management
Total marks: 40 | Time allowed: 2 hours

Candidate details

Candidate name	
Admission number	
Class / Level	ICT Level 5
Date of assessment	
Venue / Computer lab	
Start time	
Finish time	
Time allowed	2 hours

Assessor details

Assessor name	
Staff / ID number	
Department	ICT
Assessment date	
Assessor signature	

Instructions to the assessor

- Observe the candidate while they work. Award marks only if the candidate performs the step correctly.
- Award the full mark, or 0. Partial marks are allowed only where the Max marks column is 2 or more.
- Use the Remarks column to record evidence (screenshot label, file name, or what you saw).
- Tasks marked (Assessor check) must be verified in person when the candidate raises a hand. Do not award these marks from the screenshot alone.
- Ask the oral questions in Part C after the candidate has finished the practical tasks. Award the mark if the answer matches the expected answer in meaning.
- Complete the product checklist after the candidate has finished and saved all work in the folder PRACTICAL_[YourName].

Quantities are per candidate unless stated.

Requirements for the practical

No.	***Item***	***Specification / purpose***	**Qty**
1	Desktop computer or laptop	Minimum 4 GB RAM and 20 GB free disk space; used for performing all tasks	1
2	Flash disk	Minimum 1 GB, formatted and empty; Task 8 (file transfer) and Task 11 (optional BitLocker)	1
3	Mouse and keyboard	Input devices	1 set
4	Internet connection (or local network)	Cloud sharing, network sharing and email in Task 9	1
5	Printer (optional)	Printing the evidence document	1 shared
6	Candidate task sheets	Instructions	1
7	Assessor marking scheme and checklist	Marking	1 per assessor
8	Pen and blank paper	Rough work	1
9	Stopwatch or wall clock	Time keeping	1
10	Windows operating system with File Explorer	Windows 10 or 11 (Pro edition required for EFS and BitLocker); all tasks	1
11	Notepad	Built-in; Task 4 (Notes.txt)	1
12	Microsoft Word	2016 or later; Tasks 4 and 10, and the evidence document	1
13	Microsoft Excel	2016 or later; Task 4 (Budget.xlsx)	1
14	Microsoft Paint	Built-in; Task 4 (Photo1.png)	1
15	Snipping Tool or Snip & Sketch (Windows + Shift + S)	Built-in; screenshots	1
16	Compression utility	Windows built-in "Compress to ZIP file", 7-Zip or WinRAR (latest); Tasks 6, 7 and 11	1
17	Web browser	Chrome, Edge or Firefox (latest); cloud sharing in Task 9	1

18	OneDrive or Google Drive account	Active test account; Task 9 (cloud option)	1
19	Email client or webmail	Outlook or Gmail, active; Task 9 (email option)	1
20	BitLocker or VeraCrypt (optional)	Built-in or latest; Task 11 (optional method)	1

Part A: Observation checklist (25 marks)

Preparation (before Task 1)

Task: read the instructions and follow the exam rules.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
1	Reads the instructions and task sheet before starting, works individually and does not share passwords or evidence	1		
	Subtotal	**1**		

Task 1: View file details

Task: open File Explorer, go to Documents, use the Details view and record the details of any one file.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
1.1	Opens File Explorer, navigates to the Documents location and switches to the Details view	1		
1.2	Records in the Word evidence document the file name and extension, and the file type, size and date modified	1		
	Subtotal	**2**		

Task 2: Change the view and sort files

Task: apply Large icons view, sort by Date modified and take a screenshot.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
2.1	Changes the view to Large icons	1		
2.2	Sorts the files by Date modified and takes a screenshot showing both settings applied	1		
	Subtotal	**2**		

Task 3: Create the folder structure

Task: create the main folder on the Desktop and the three subfolders.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
3.1	Creates the main folder PRACTICAL_[YourName] on the Desktop	1		
3.2	Creates the subfolders Reports, Images and Backup inside the main folder, correctly named	1		
	Subtotal	**2**		

Task 4: Create files

Task: create the four files and save each in the folder indicated.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
4.1	Creates Notes.txt in Notepad, saved in Reports, containing full name, class and today's date	1		
4.2	Creates Budget.xlsx in Excel, saved in Reports, containing any five items with their prices	1		
4.3	Creates Letter.docx in Word, saved in Reports, containing a three-line letter to a friend	1		
4.4	Creates Photo1.png in Paint, saved in Images, containing a simple drawing	1		
	Subtotal	**4**		

Task 5: Rename, copy, delete and restore files (Assessor check)

Task: rename, copy and delete files, then restore the deleted file from the Recycle Bin.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
5.1	Renames Notes.txt to Class_Notes.txt	1		
5.2	Copies Letter.docx into the Backup folder (the original remains in Reports)	1		
5.3	Deletes Photo1.png and restores it from the Recycle Bin	1		
	Subtotal	**3**		

Task 6: Compress files

Task: compress the Reports folder and move the ZIP file into the Backup folder.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
6.1	Compresses the Reports folder into a ZIP file	1		
6.2	Names the ZIP file Reports_Compressed.zip	1		
6.3	Moves the ZIP file into the Backup folder	1		
	Subtotal	**3**		

Task 7: Extract files and compare sizes

Task: extract the ZIP file and compare the size of the Reports folder with the ZIP file.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
7.1	Extracts Reports_Compressed.zip into a new folder named Extracted inside the main folder	1		
7.2	Records the size of the Reports folder and the size of the ZIP file in the evidence document	1		
	Subtotal	**2**		

Task 8: Transfer a file

Task: transfer Letter.docx to a flash disk or to a second folder on another drive.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
8.1	Transfers Letter.docx to a flash disk or to a second folder on another drive and takes a screenshot showing the file in its destination	1		
	Subtotal	**1**		

Task 9: Share the Backup folder

Task: share the Backup folder using one of the three methods given.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
9.1	Shares the Backup folder using one method: network sharing with Read permission to Everyone, cloud sharing with a "view only" link, or attaching the ZIP file to an email draft, and takes a screenshot of the sharing settings or the attached file	1		
	Subtotal	**1**		

Task 10: Password protection

Task: protect Letter.docx with a password and show the password prompt.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
10.1	Opens Letter.docx and sets the password given in the task sheet using File > Info > Protect Document > Encrypt with Password	2		
10.2	Closes and reopens the file to show the password prompt, and takes a screenshot	1		
	Subtotal	**3**		

Task 11: Encryption (Assessor check)

Task: encrypt a file or folder using one of the methods given.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
11.1	Encrypts a file or folder using one method (Encrypt contents to secure data on the Backup folder, a password-protected ZIP using 7-Zip or WinRAR, or BitLocker/VeraCrypt on a removable drive if permitted) and takes a screenshot showing the encryption setting applied	1		
	Subtotal	**1**		

Observation checklist summary

Section	Max marks	Marks awarded
Preparation (before Task 1)	1	
Task 1: View file details	2	
Task 2: Change the view and sort files	2	
Task 3: Create the folder structure	2	
Task 4: Create files	4	
Task 5: Rename, copy, delete and restore files	3	
Task 6: Compress files	3	
Task 7: Extract files and compare sizes	2	
Task 8: Transfer a file	1	
Task 9: Share the Backup folder	1	
Task 10: Password protection	3	
Task 11: Encryption	1	
Total for observation checklist	**25**	

Part B: Product checklist (5 marks)

Complete this after the candidate has saved all work.

No.	*Item to be evaluated*	Met	Max marks	Marks awarded	Remarks
1	Folder PRACTICAL_[YourName] is on the Desktop and contains Reports, Images, Backup and Extracted, with every file correctly named and saved in the right folder	☐ Yes ☐ No	1		
2	Word evidence document named Evidence_[YourName] is saved inside the main folder	☐ Yes ☐ No	1		
3	Required screenshots (Tasks 2, 8, 9, 10 and 11) are pasted into the evidence document and each is labelled with its Task number	☐ Yes ☐ No	1		
4	Recorded details are accurate: file details in Task 1, and the Reports folder and ZIP file sizes in Task 7	☐ Yes ☐ No	1		
5	Evidence document is neatly presented and is the candidate's own work, with no shared passwords or evidence	☐ Yes ☐ No	1		
	Total for product checklist		**5**		

Part C: Oral questions (10 marks)

Ask each question orally and award the mark if the answer matches the expected answer.

No.	*Question*	*Expected answer*	Max marks	Marks awarded
1	Name any two details shown in the Details view of File Explorer.	Any two of: name, date modified, type, size.	1	
2	What is the difference between copying and moving a file?	Copying makes a duplicate and leaves the original in place; moving transfers the file so it no longer exists in the original location.	1	
3	What happens to a file when you delete it, and how can you get it back?	It goes to the Recycle Bin; open the Recycle Bin, right-click the file and select Restore.	1	
4	Why do we compress files into a ZIP file?	To reduce file size, to group several files into one, and to make storing, sharing and emailing easier.	1	
5	Why should important files be protected with a password or encryption?	To prevent unauthorised access and keep confidential data safe, since the file cannot be opened or read without the password or key.	1	
6	What is a file extension? Give two examples.	The characters after the dot in a file name that show the file type, for example .txt, .docx, .xlsx, .png or .zip.	1	
7	Why do we organise files into folders and subfolders?	To keep related files together, make files easy to find and manage, and avoid clutter.	1	
8	Name two ways of transferring a file to another location or device.	Any two of: flash disk, another drive or folder, email attachment, cloud storage, network sharing.	1	
9	What is the difference between network sharing and cloud sharing?	Network sharing gives access to people on the same local network; cloud sharing (OneDrive or Google Drive) gives access over the internet through a link.	1	
10	Why should you keep a backup copy of important files?	To avoid losing data through accidental deletion, corruption, theft or hardware failure, and to be able to restore it.	1	
	Total for oral questions		**10**	

Overall result

Part	Max marks	Marks awarded
Part A: Observation checklist	25	
Part B: Product checklist	5	
Part C: Oral questions	10	
Total	**40**	

Competence decision: ☐ Competent ☐ Not yet competent

Assessor's comments

Area	Comments
Strengths observed	
Areas needing improvement	
Observations on safety, ethics and professional conduct	
Recommendations and follow-up action	
Overall comments	

Assessor's name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Candidate's feedback

To be completed by the candidate after the assessment.

Statement	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree
I understood the instructions and the tasks	☐	☐	☐
I was told the assessment criteria before starting	☐	☐	☐
The time allowed was enough	☐	☐	☐
The computer, software and internet were adequate	☐	☐	☐
The assessment was conducted fairly	☐	☐	☐
I received useful feedback from the assessor	☐	☐	☐

Question	Candidate's response
What went well?	
What did you find difficult?	
What would you improve or do differently?	
Suggestions for improving this assessment	

Outcome: ☐ I accept the assessment result ☐ I wish to appeal

Candidate's name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Declarations and signatures

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Candidate (I confirm this work is my own)			
Assessor			
Internal verifier			